

American Pie (Rhythm Guitar) -- Don McLean

From *American Pie* (1971). About 138 BPM for the band sections, est. The intro is slow and free-time.

An eight-and-a-half-minute folk-rock epic: a solo-voice intro, then an acoustic-and-piano-led full band strumming through verse after verse.

The record is acoustic-guitar driven. On a Strat, CTL off is a bright acoustic-ish strum. CTL on is a warmer, pushed electric voice for fills and for doubling the melody in later choruses.

Instrument: Stratocaster (HSS). Position 4 (neck+middle) for the strum. Bridge for the pushed voice.

GP-5 only, Stratocaster (HSS), no pedalboard.

AMP: Bellman 59N (Bassman Normal) + CAB: EVM112 IR (User IR 5)

A '59 Bassman normal is warm, full, and clean until pushed. It works as an acoustic-ish strum clean and takes a light drive for the fills.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 12.

Low.

PRE -- COMP (Ross), always on.

Sustain: 40, VOL: 55.

Even, acoustic-like strum.

DST -- Green OD (TS-808), on CTL.

Gain: 26, Tone: 55, VOL: 66.

A light push for fills and melody doubling in the later, bigger choruses.

AMP -- Bellman 59N, always on.

Gain: 30, PRES: 50, VOL: 62, Bass: 48, Middle: 45, Treble: 56.

Clean and warm. Middle 45 for less electric honk.

CAB -- User IR 5 (EVM112), always on.

VOL: 60.

EQ -- Guitar EQ 2, always on.

100Hz: -1, 500Hz: -2, 1kHz: 0, 3kHz: +2, 6kHz: +1, VOL: 50.

The 500Hz dip and 3kHz and 6kHz air make it acoustic-adjacent.

MOD -- off.

DLY -- Analog, on CTL.

Mix: 12, Time: 330ms, F.Back: 15, Trail: on.

A short tail for the fills.

RVB -- Room, always on.

Mix: 16, Decay: 32, Trail: on.

A natural room.

CTL footswitch

On CTL: DST (Green OD), DLY (Analog).

- **CTL off** -- Rhythm. Bright, compressed acoustic-ish strum. That's most of this song. This is the resting state the patch loads into.

- **CTL on** -- Lead. A warm push plus a short tail for fills and melody doubling.

Stay off for the strum, which is most of the eight minutes. Engage for fills and the big late choruses.